Professional Ethics
Previous Year Question Paper Analysis

10 Osmania University papers · Aug/Sep 2013 to Nov 2022 · 90 questions (50 short notes, 40 essays)

10/10	8/10	44%	57/90
papers asked misconduct / disciplinary	had an accounting essay	of questions from Unit I	questions are repeats

Summary

Professional misconduct and disciplinary proceedings appeared in **all 10 papers**; accountancy for lawyers and enrolment followed with **8 papers each**.

Paper pattern (unchanged in all 10 papers): 2 hours, 50 marks. Part A: any 3 of 5 short notes × 6 = 18. Part B: any 2 of 4 essays × 16 = 32. The other 50 marks of the paper are for the record (30) and viva voce (20).

1. **Misconduct and disciplinary committees are certain** — 9 short notes and 8 essays; an essay in 7 of 10 papers.
2. **Accountancy is almost a fixed Part B essay** — 8 of 10 papers (usually question 9); absent only in Jan 2020 and Sep 2021, back in Nov 2022.
3. **Unit I carries the most questions (44%)** — enrolment, right to practise, history of the profession.
4. **Short notes repeat word for word** — misconduct (6), solicitors firm (5), legal aid (5), Bar-Bench relations (4): 20 of the 50 short notes.
5. **2021–2022 added new angles** — Article 19(1)(g), restrictions on Senior Advocates, the profession in business or industry, the State Bar Council's committees. **AIBE**, though in the syllabus, has never been asked.

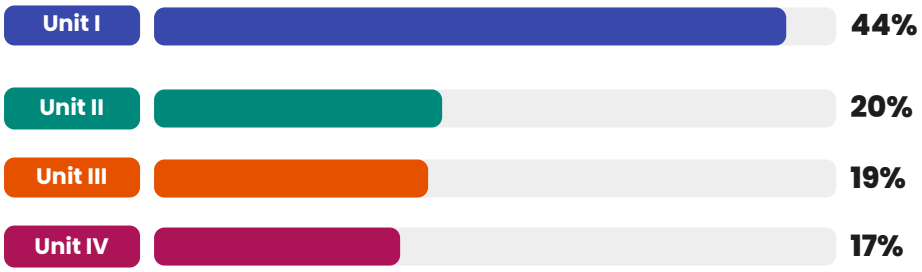
Papers: Aug/Sep 2013 · Jan/Feb 2014 · Dec 2015 · May/Jun 2016 · Jan/Feb 2017 · Jan/Feb 2018 · Jan/Feb 2019 · Jan 2020 · Sep 2021 · Nov 2022. No 2023–2025 papers could be found.

Topic ranking — ten topics cover all 90 questions

#	Topic	Papers (of 10)	Part A	Part B	Not asked in
1	Professional misconduct & disciplinary committees	10	9	8	—
2	Enrolment, disqualification & right to practise (incl. Art. 19(1)(g))	8	10	4	2016, 2018
3	Accountancy for lawyers (nature, branches, rules)	8	3	8	2020, 2021
4	Duties of an advocate (client, court, colleagues, public; BCI code)	8	4	5	2015, 2021
5	Legal profession — history, Advocates Act, nature, legal education, welfare fund, Senior Advocates	7	5	6	2017, 2020, 2022
6	Bar Council of India & State Bar Councils — powers, functions, committees	6	1	6	2013, 2016, 2017, 2019
7	Advocacy — seven lamps & elements	6	4	3	2017–2020
8	Legal aid	5	5	0	2013, 2014, 2016, 2017, 2022
9	Solicitors firm	5	5	0	2013, 2016, 2017, 2020, 2021
10	Bar-Bench relations	5	4	1	2013, 2014, 2016, 2020, 2022

Sep 2021 asked Bar-Bench relations inside an essay on the elements of advocacy. Legal aid, solicitors firm and Bar-Bench relations are short-note-only topics; Bar Council questions come almost only as essays.

Unit-wise distribution



40 questions · A 23 · B 17 — profession, Advocates Act, enrolment, right to practise, Bar Councils

18 questions · A 11 · B 7 — seven lamps, duties, legal aid

17 questions · A 9 · B 8 — misconduct, disciplinary proceedings

15 questions · A 7 · B 8 — accountancy, Bar-Bench

General powers of the Bar Councils are counted in Unit I; their role in disciplinary proceedings in Unit III. Units I, II and III appeared in every paper; Unit IV was absent only in Jan 2020 and Sep 2021.

Repeated questions — nine recurring questions account for 57 of the 90

Question as usually worded	Part	Times	Papers
Professional misconduct	A	6	2013, 2015, 2016, 2017, 2019, 2020
Solicitors firm	A	5	2014, 2015, 2018, 2019, 2022
Legal aid / duty towards legal aid	A	5	2015, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021
Powers and functions of the Bar Council of India / Bar Councils	B	5	2014, 2015, 2018, 2020, 2021
Accounting — branches, nature and functions, or rules for lawyers	B	8	every paper except 2020 and 2021
Disciplinary committee / proceedings — powers, functions, procedure	A/B	11	2013, 2014, 2016 (×2), 2017 (×2), 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022
Bar-Bench relations	A	4	2015, 2017, 2018, 2019
Seven lamps of advocacy	A/B	4	2013, 2014, 2016, 2022
Enrolment / qualifications and disqualifications	A/B	9	2013, 2015, 2017 (×2), 2019, 2020 (×3), 2022

- **Part B nearly always has one accounting essay and one Bar Council or disciplinary essay**; the other two rotate among duties, history, enrolment and advocacy.
- **Identical essays:** "Development of legal profession in India" (2013, 2018); "Branches of accounting relevant to the advocates" (2014, 2015); "Salient features of the Advocates Act" (2016, 2021).
- **Disciplinary questions move between parts** — a short note in 2018 and 2022, an essay in 2017, 2020 and 2021.
- **Duty questions are named by audience** — clients, colleagues, court, other advocates, public; the Jan 2020 paper added "with decided cases".

Recent trends and gaps

- **Right to practise became a theme** — Sep 2021 asked Article 19(1)(g), "Right to practise — a privilege" and "Legal profession in a business or industry"; Nov 2022 asked "Right to practice" again.
- **New topics:** restrictions on Senior Advocates (2021), committees of the State Bar Council and the admission committee (2022).
- **Accountancy skipped two papers** (Jan 2020, Sep 2021) and returned in Nov 2022.

Syllabus item	Unit	Times asked
All India Bar Examination (AIBE)	I	0
Removal from the rolls	III	0 (only disqualification is asked)
Accounting and law	IV	0 as a separate question
Bar Council code of ethics	II	1 (2014)
Duties towards the public	II	1 (2020)
Duties towards colleagues	II	2 (2017, 2018)

Suggested priorities: four essays (misconduct & disciplinary committees, accountancy, Bar Councils, enrolment) and eight short notes (misconduct, solicitors firm, legal aid, Bar-Bench, disciplinary committee, seven lamps / elements, right to practise & Art. 19(1)(g), enrolment & disqualification) would have answered both parts in 9 of the 10 papers (all except Jan/Feb 2014). These priorities show what has been asked, not a prediction.

Appendix — all 90 questions by paper

Paper	Part A — short notes	Part B — essays
Nov 2022	1. Seven lamps of advocacy 2. Solicitors firm 3. Right to practice 4. Powers of State Bar Council 5. Disciplinary committee	6. Enrolment of an advocate 7. Committees of the State Bar Council, especially the admission committee 8. Accountancy 9. Duties of an advocate under the Advocates Act
Sep 2021	1. Legal aid 2. Legal profession in a business or industry 3. Article 19(1)(g) 4. Restrictions on Senior Advocate 5. Right to practise a privilege	6. Essential elements of advocacy and Bench-Bar relations 7. Procedure to prove or disprove misconduct of an advocate 8. Functions of Bar Council of India 9. Salient features of the Advocates Act
Jan 2020	1. Disqualification of an advocate 2. Legal aid 3. Duty towards client 4. Enrolment of an advocate 5. Professional misconduct	6. Who is an advocate? Procedure for admission 7. Powers of Bar Councils to maintain standards of the profession 8. Powers and functions of the disciplinary committee 9. Duties towards public and court, with cases
Jan/Feb 2019	1. Enrolment of advocates 2. Advocate's duty towards legal aid to the poor 3. Professional misconduct 4. Bar-Bench relations 5. Solicitors firm	6. Significant changes in the legal profession after Independence 7. Duties of advocates — standards of professional conduct and etiquette 8. How misconduct cases against advocates are decided by the Bar Council 9. Nature and functions of accounting in the legal profession
Jan/Feb 2018	1. Solicitors firms 2. Legal aid 3. Disciplinary committee 4. Bar-Bench relations 5. Important branches of accounting	6. Development of legal profession in India 7. Powers and functions of Bar Council of India 8. Duties of advocates towards client, courts and other advocates 9. Rules relating to accounting of lawyers
Jan/Feb 2017	1. Practice of law 2. Duty towards colleagues 3. Misconduct 4. Disqualification 5. Bar-Bench relations	6. Body or authority empowered to punish professional or other misconduct 7. Regulation governing enrolment and practice 8. Nature and functions of accounting 9. Functions of the disciplinary committees
May/Jun 2016	1. Elements of advocacy 2. Advocate's duty towards clients 3. Professional misconduct 4. Disciplinary committees 5. Important branches of accountancy	6. Salient features of the Advocates Act, 1961 7. Seven lamps of advocacy 8. Functions of BCI and State Bar Councils in disciplinary proceedings 9. Need for accountancy for lawyers
Dec 2015	1. Legal aid 2. Solicitors firm 3. Bar-Bench relations 4. Elements of advocacy 5. Professional misconduct	6. 'Legal profession is a noble profession, not a trade or business' — comment 7. Powers and functions of Bar Council of India 8. Qualifications and disqualifications for enrolment 9. Branches of accounting relevant to advocates
Jan/Feb 2014	1. Right to practice 2. Legal education 3. Solicitors firm 4. Advocates Welfare Fund 5. Bar Council code of ethics	6. Seven lamps of advocacy 7. Professional misconduct and procedure for disciplinary proceedings 8. Powers and functions of Bar Council of India 9. Branches of accounting relevant to advocates
Aug/Sep 2013	1. Indian Bar Council Act 2. Disqualification of enrolment 3. Professional misconduct 4. Seven lamps of advocacy 5. Accounting for lawyers	6. Development of legal profession in India 7. 'Advocate owes respect and courtesy to the court' — comment 8. Procedure of the State Bar Council's disciplinary committee on a complaint 9. 'An advocate should keep accounts of client's money' — rules of accountancy

Questions lightly paraphrased. Source: Osmania University question papers shared by the faculty (2013–2020) and the Sep 2021 and Nov 2022 papers.

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lawsticker-ai.com · as per previous year question paper analysis — a look back, not a prediction